

exhibition

A Montage of Life

KOLKATA/ DELHI A humble girl from a village and later the wife of a vegetable vendor, Shakila Sheikh, 39, has mesmerised the world of art for years. The brilliant collages of this natural artist have inspired many. Discovered by noted collage artist B.R. Panesar as a child, she was introduced to the field by Panesar in the 1980s. She has neither a formal education nor training in art. Sheikh's collages, made usually out of torn magazine pages, are powerful yet sensitive reflections of humanity. In her forthcoming exhibition at the CIMA Gallery, to be held from July 25 to August 9, her latest works will be displayed, in which one can see how her art has matured with time. Her pieces have taken on a sculptural quality and she is also working on installations.

A work, *Turmoil*, is evocative in spirit, showing the male and female forms against a dark background,

bringing out the most intimate of human feelings. Another work, *Alms*, is almost pictorial in nature. Some untitled works, depicting nature, her first love, will also be exhibited. Sheikh had not held an exhibition since 2003 though she took part in the Freedom exhibitions this year. Known as one who has ripped into the traditional bastions, she is ready to let her art do the talking again.

In Delhi, Threshold Gallery features *Mapping Memories: Part Two of Painted Travelogues of Bali and Burma*. It exhibits the work of five painters,

among them John Tunsein, V. Ramesh, Gargi Raina and Jayshree Chakravarty. Tunsein's is a rain-soaked image of a landscape with a gentle Burmese monk in the foreground, while Raina's has dream-like images of pagodas bathed in an orange red glow. Anjolie Ela Menon's oil on Masonite board is hypnotic and introspective. From July 21 to August 6.

by Elora Sen



AT A STROKE: Sheikh's work; Anjolie Ela Menon's work (top)



art exhibition

Aspiration to Inspiration

DELHI Gallery Espace presents 'Recent Works by Amit Ambalal', an exhibition of oil paintings on canvas and sculptures in bronze by the Ahmedabad-based veteran artist Amit Ambalal. Enraptured by his dream of becoming a painter, he sold his family-owned business (a textile mill) in 1977 to pursue his passion. A pupil of veteran artist Chhaganlal Jadhav, Ambalal's engagement with the arts extends to a wide ground of historical research, documentation and, importantly, with the Nathdwara school of painting. Ambalal is a satirist-painter who develops parody, caricature and mimicry into images taken from everyday life. The works have a directness of appeal that gives them an assertive quality. The paintings have the autobiographical narrative with Ambalal, his wife, their dog and Lord Hanuman—figures from known and imagined spaces. From July 21 to August 12.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

Ambalal's Peeping Tom



art

Picasso at Work

BANGALORE One of India's best-known artists will show his latest collection, *Metamorphoses*, in Bangalore. Jehangir Jani, in his recent works, explores sculptures in fibreglass, gold leaf, ceramics and metal sheet, besides watercolours, oils and drawings. He portrays the ever-changing world



A work by Jehangir Jani

and reflects the depth of everything from identity to thought processes. From July 23 to August 6. At Gallery Sumukha.